

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY

**ATTACK REPORT**

Latrodectus The Silent Assassin Sneaking Past Defenses

Date of Publication

April 10, 2024

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2024136

Summary

First Seen: November 2023

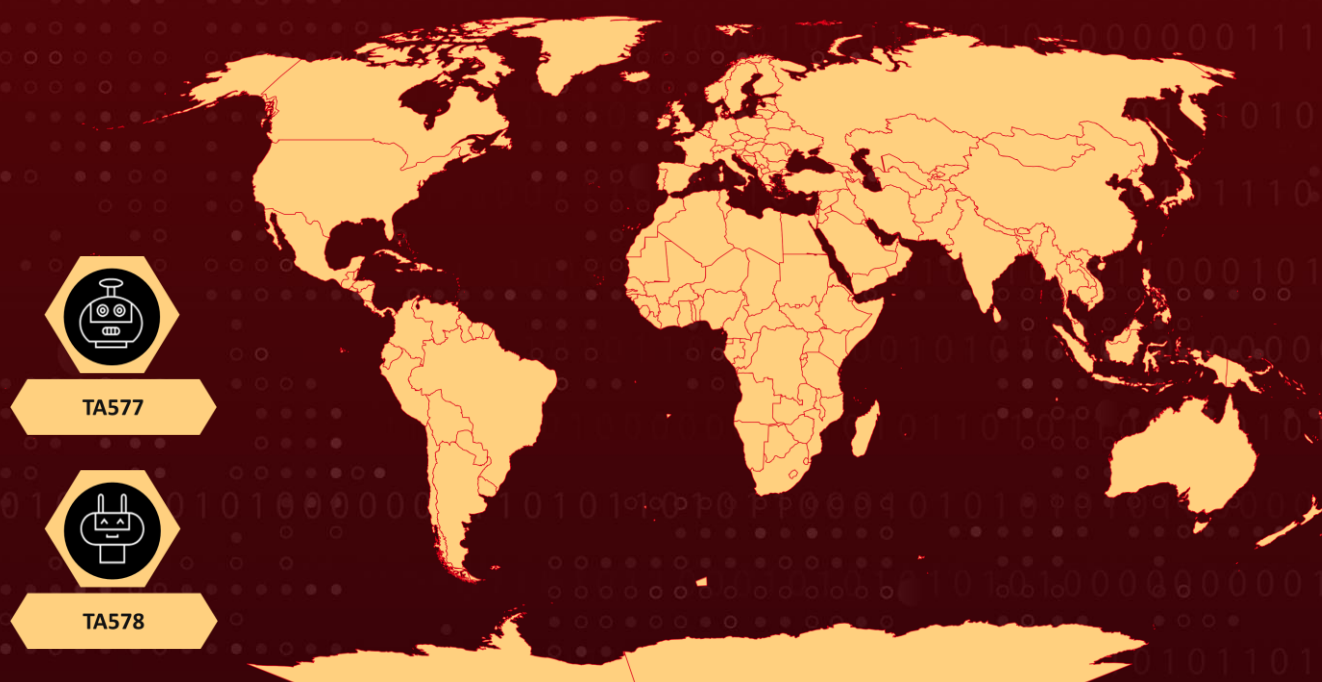
Malware: Latrodectus downloader

Threat Actors: TA577 and TA578

Attack Region: Worldwide

Attack: Latrodectus, a newly emerged malware believed to be an evolution of the IcedID loader, has been detected in malicious email campaigns since November 2023. It is suspected that the creators of IcedID are behind Latrodectus. Initially observed in the hands of TA577, an Initial Access Broker.

Attack Regions



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Attack Details

#1

A new strain of malware known as Latrodectus seems to have evolved from the IcedID loader, which has been involved in malicious email campaigns since November 2023.

#2

Latrodectus functions as an emerging downloader, equipped with advanced sandbox evasion capabilities and showing structural resemblances to prior IcedID activities. It's anticipated that Latrodectus is the creation of the same malicious actors behind the IcedID malware.

#3

Initially, Latrodectus was identified in the possession of TA577, an Initial Access Broker, who began using the new downloader shortly after the turmoil caused by QBot in 2023. TA577 employed Latrodectus in at least three campaigns during November 2023 before reverting to Pikabot.

#4

By mid-January 2024, Latrodectus had become predominantly linked with TA578 in email-based threat operations, sometimes propagated through a DanaBot infection. The attack begins with the threat actor completing online contact forms to send fabricated copyright infringement notices to targeted organizations.

#5

Latrodectus, functioning as a downloader, is designed to fetch payloads and execute arbitrary commands. Following mandatory environment and mutex checks, the malware starts by sending a victim registration report to its operators.

#6

Further victim details can be acquired through instructions from the command and control (C2) server. It is expected that Latrodectus will gain popularity among financially motivated threat actors, particularly those who have previously distributed IcedID.

Recommendations



Enhance Email Security Measures: Given that Latrodectus has been detected in malicious email campaigns since November 2023, it's crucial to bolster email security protocols. Implementing advanced email filtering and scanning technologies can help detect and block suspicious emails containing malware payloads.



Network Segmentation: Implement network segmentation to minimize the lateral movement of attackers within the network, limiting their ability to access critical systems and data.



Zero Trust Architecture: Adopt a Zero Trust security architecture, where trust is never assumed and continuous authentication and authorization mechanisms are implemented, reducing the risk of unauthorized access.



Monitoring and Logging: Implement robust monitoring and logging mechanisms to detect suspicious activity or unauthorized access to your accounts. Regularly review access logs and audit trails for unusual patterns or login locations.



Heighten Employee Awareness: Educate employees on cybersecurity best practices, emphasizing the importance of vigilance against phishing attempts. Encourage reporting of any suspicious emails or activities.



Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion
<u>TA0007</u> Discovery	<u>TA0040</u> Impact	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>TA0010</u> Exfiltration
<u>T1566</u> Phishing	<u>T1059</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter	<u>T1543</u> Create or Modify System Process	<u>T1574</u> Hijack Execution Flow

<u>T1574.002</u> DLL Side-Loading	<u>T1055</u> Process Injection	<u>T1497</u> Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion	<u>T1083</u> File and Directory Discovery
<u>T1057</u> Process Discovery	<u>T1082</u> System Information Discovery	<u>T1105</u> Ingress Tool Transfer	<u>T1041</u> Exfiltration Over C2 Channel

✂ Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	db03a34684feab7475862080f59d4d99b32c74d3a152a53b257fd1a443e8ee77, e99f3517a36a9f7a55335699cfb4d84d08b042d47146119156f7f3bab580b4d7, bb525dc6b7a7ebefd040e01fd48d7d4e178f8d9e5dec9033078ced4e9aa4e241, 97e093f2e0bf6dec8392618722dd6b4411088fe752bedece910d11fffe0288a2, f9c69e79e7799df31d6516df70148d7832b121d330beebe52cff6606f0724c62, d9471b038c44619739176381815bfa9a13b5ff77021007a4ede9b146ed2e04ec, d98cd810d568f338f16c4637e8a9cb01ff69ee1967f4cfc004de3f283d61ba81, 47d66c576393a4256d94f5ed1e77adc28426dea027f7a23e2dbf41b93b87bd78, 5d881d14d2336273e531b1b3d6f2d907539fe8489cbe80533280c9c72efa2273, 10c129e2310342a55df5fa88331f338452835790a379d5230ee8de7d5f28ea1a, 781c63cf4981fa6aff002188307b278fac9785ca66f0b6dfcf68adbe7512e491, aa29a8af8d615b1dd9f52fd49d42563fbaefa35ff0ab1b4afc4cb2b2fa54a119, 0ac5030e2171914f43e0769cb10b602683ccc9da09369bcd4b80da6edb8be80e, 0e96cf6166b7cc279f99d6977ab0f45e9f47e827b8a24d6665ac4c29e18b5ce0, 77270e13d01b2318a3f27a9a477b8386f1a0ebc6d44a2c7e185cfbe55aac8017, e7ff6a7ac5bfb0bb29547d413591abc7628c7d5576a3b43f6d8e5d95769e553a,

TYPE	VALUE
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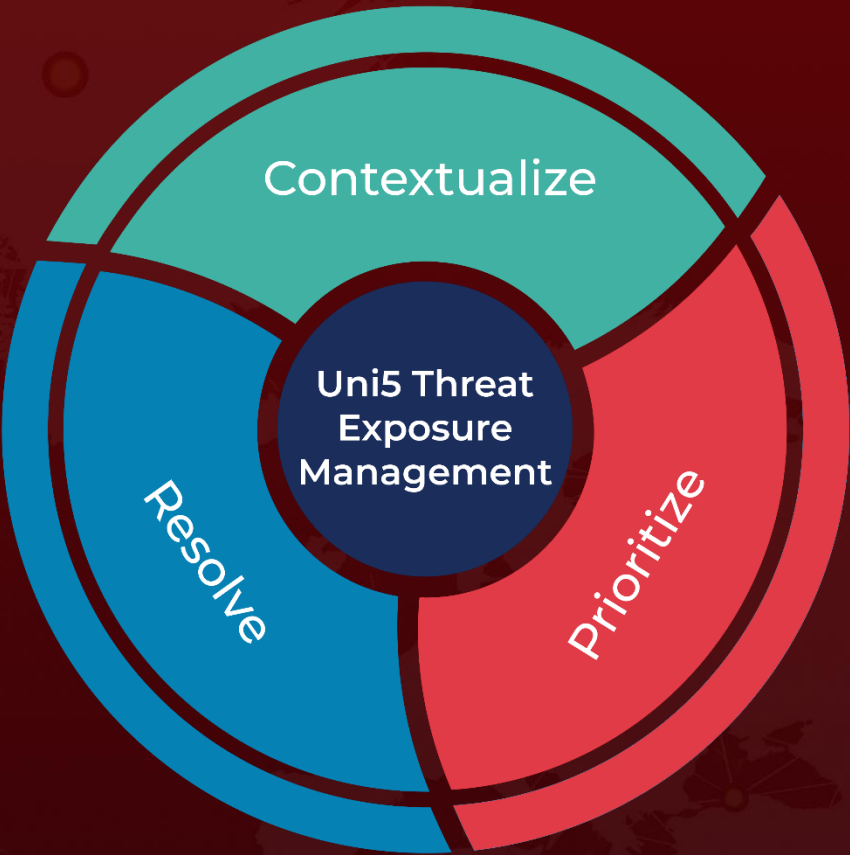
References

<https://www.proofpoint.com/us/blog/threat-insight/latrodectus-spider-bytes-ice>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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